Final project question bank

HIST 212 · Workshop November 3 · Submit November 4, 11:59 p.m. Central

Choose one question. Start with two passages. Use the webpage for people, source links, and a specific first step.

Politics

Who won the Great Debate—and why didn't the losers disappear?

Start: Analects 2.3 + Han Feizi 7 (p. 333)

Why wasn't there another Qin—or was there?

Start: Li Si (SCT 207–212) + Lu Jia, New Discourses

How could Korea and Japan borrow China's institutions without accepting China's rule?

Start: Silla's reply (SKT 64–65) + Taika edicts (SJT 77–79)

War

Why did rulers celebrate wars that Mozi condemned?

Start: Mozi 17 + Salt and Iron, minister (CC 61)

How did Buddhists justify fighting wars?

Start: Wŏn'gwang (SKT 45–46) + Huiyuan (SCT 427–429)

When is rebellion the right thing to do?

Start: Mengzi 1B8 + Han Feizi 7 (p. 333)

Culture

Why did rulers need monks—and sometimes fear them?

Start: Huiyuan (SCT 427–429) + Wang Geon, injunctions 1–2 (SKT 154)

Could a woman influence politics without holding office?

Start: Genji, ch. 1 + Zhu Xi's Ancestral Rites (CC 157–163)

What ancient ideas still live on today—and who kept them alive?

Start: Laozi 37 + Han Feizi 5 (pp. 324–325)

Economics

Salt and Iron: should the state run the economy?

Start: Salt and Iron (CC 61): minister + learned men

Does a strong state need weak people?

Start: Lord Shang 20.1 (p. 143) + Mengzi 1A7

Why did rulers call farming essential and commerce dangerous?

Start: Lord Shang 3.2 (p. 134) + Salt and Iron (CC 61)

Finish the Question and evidence submission

1. State your historical question and give a tentative answer.
2. Quote two short passages. Cite each source and page/section.
3. Explain who is speaking, the situation, and how each passage supports or challenges your answer.

Submit about one page in Canvas. Salt and Iron's two speakers count as one source.

For the final: two periods, three East Asian societies, four primary sources. Trace a connection to the present; resemblance alone does not prove inheritance.